Xiaofeng Gong

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics | Department of Economics, University of Connecticut
Expected Ph.D. conferral: May 2027 | xiaofeng.econ@gmail.com
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Research Fields

Primary: Industrial Organization; Economics of Innovation; Digital Economy; Intellectual Property; Open-Source Software
Secondary: Political Economy; International Economics; Media Economics; Law and Economics; Industrial Policy; Economics of Crime; Strategic Technologies
Methods: Applied microeconomic theory; dynamic models; computational equilibrium methods; applied microeconometrics; survival and hazard analysis; LLM-assisted data construction

Education

University of Connecticut, Department of Economics
Ph.D. in Economics, 2022-present; expected May 2027
Dissertation: *Zero-Price Intellectual Properties and Profit-Oriented Firms*
Advisor: Talia Bar. Dissertation committee: Talia Bar, Ling Huang, Mike Shor, and Stephen L. Ross.
Dissertation proposal approved April 2026.

London School of Economics and Political Science
M.Sc. in Economics, 2020-2022

University of Connecticut
B.S. in Mathematics and Economics, 2016-2020; double major; Honors in Economics

Publications

Zhong, Chunping, and **Xiaofeng Gong**. 2023. "Economic and Financial Sanctions: Academic Progress and Disputes" [经济金融制裁研究的进展与争议]. *Russian, East European & Central Asian Studies*, no. 1: 12-34. DOI: 10.20018/j.cnki.reecas.2023.01.002.

Zhong, Chunping, Yuechuan Zhao, and **Xiaofeng Gong**. 2026. "Why Is It Difficult for Sanctions to Achieve Their Intended Goals? Evidence from the Global Sanctions Database" [制裁为什么难以达成预设目标？——来自全球制裁数据库的宏观经济效应证据]. *Eurasian Economy*, no. 3: 50-73.

Job Market Paper

Cathedrals Opening Bazaars: Placing Open-Source Software in the Patent Technology Space. Solo-authored. Job market paper; draft available. When firms make technology public through open-source code, do they reveal the technologies they protect with patents, or a separate set? I link Compustat firms to their USPTO patents and to their GitHub accounts, and a large language model places their open-source projects in the patent classification. In the average firm-year, 35% of a firm's open-source code lies in technologies it does not patent, against 15% under a randomization benchmark built from the firm's own items. The excess of the distance between its open-source code and its patents over this benchmark rises with the count of open-source projects about as much as in simulated firms that keep one technology mix at every size. Outside its patented technologies, a firm's open-source code is less co-located with its nearest technology neighbors' patents than under the benchmark, consistent with the stated prediction that firms reveal less where rivals can use more of what is disclosed. Within a firm, however, new participants make up a larger share of projects inside its patented technologies than of its other projects, unlike the prediction that communities participate less near patented inventions.

Working Papers

The Ethnic Composition of Inventors in Entrepreneurial Firms. With Talia Bar and Delia Furtado. Submitted to the *Handbook of Research on Immigration and Entrepreneurship*. Examines the representation of Chinese and Indian inventors on patents awarded to young U.S. firms and discusses how early-career visa constraints may help explain their underrepresentation.

When Open-Source and Proprietary Innovation Suppress Each Other. Solo-authored. Work in progress. Develops a dynamic quality-ladder model linking proprietary pricing, decentralized open-source contribution, and investment incentives.

Strategic Ignorance in Media Markets: Unauthorized Distribution and Foreign Entry. Solo-authored. Work in progress. Studies foreign media entry with endogenous copyright enforcement and unauthorized pre-entry distribution as an audience-building channel.

Why Do Sanctions Persist? Rents and Endogenous Domestic Political Power. With Yuechuan Zhao and Chunping Zhong. Submitted to *Comparative Economic Studies*. Develops a dynamic public-choice model of why comparable external sanctions generate persistent noncompliance in some target countries but not in others.

Do Subsidies Work When Technology Access Is Restricted? A Schumpeterian Model of Strategic-Sector Industrial Policy. With Chunping Zhong. Work in progress. Studies how restrictions on foreign technology access change the return to domestic research support in a two-country growth economy.

Measuring Racial Disparities in Police Stops: Evidence from Telemetric Mobility Data. With Yuling Han, Susan Parker, Matthew B. Ross, and Stephen L. Ross. Submitted to the *Quarterly Journal of Economics*. NBER Economics of Crime Working Group conference paper.

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Telemetric Data Project, Stephen L. Ross
Department of Economics, University of Connecticut | September 2023-present
Data cleaning, regression programming, empirical implementation, and mathematical and statistical calculations.

Research Assistant, Connecticut Bail Bond Project, Stephen L. Ross
Department of Economics, University of Connecticut | September 2025-present
Data cleaning, court-record construction, and regression analysis.

Additional Experience (Undergraduate)

Intern, China Development Bank (Headquarters, Beijing) | June-August 2017
Participated in Belt and Road-related research; hosted visiting delegations from foreign development banks and participated in related conferences.

Quantitative Trading Development Intern, CICC Quantitative Fund program, Renmin University of China | July-August 2018
Participated in the development of quantitative trading systems.

Grants and Funding

Art Wright Fund Research Grant, University of Connecticut | 2026 — $2,675 for *Open-Source Engagement, IP Alignment, and Investor Signals*, under the supervision of Professor Talia Bar.

Graduate Assistantship and Tuition Waiver, University of Connecticut | 2022-present; **Eleanor Bloom Funding, Department of Economics, University of Connecticut** | Annual award, 2022-present.

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, ECON 1201 Principles of Microeconomics, University of Connecticut | Fall 2025
Enrollment: 60. Median student evaluation: 4.0/5.0.

Instructor of Record, ECON 1202 Honors Principles of Macroeconomics, University of Connecticut | Spring 2026
Enrollment: 14. Median student evaluation: 4.0/5.0 (3 of 14 students responded).

Presentations and Conferences

NBER Economics of Crime Working Group Meeting | Spring 2026 — *Measuring Racial Disparities in Police Stops: Evidence from Telemetric Mobility Data* on program; coauthor presented; attended.

Research Tools

Programming and formal methods: Python; Stata; R; MATLAB; Lean 4; LaTeX
Data construction and reproducibility: Schema-constrained LLM workflows; automated data labeling and verification; API-based data pipelines; testing, provenance, and source registries
Research data and platforms: WRDS (Compustat, CRSP, I/B/E/S); LSEG Workspace; GitHub API; GH Archive; USPTO; GSDB; WDI

Languages

Mandarin Chinese; English

References

Department of Economics, University of Connecticut.

- **Talia Bar** (Advisor)
- Ling Huang
- Owen Svalestad
- Stephen L. Ross